

Woolly mammoth

WULL-ee MAMM-oth

- **When** 5 million–10,000 years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America, Europe, Asia, Africa
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Length** 16 ft (5 m)

Long, shaggy hair with fine wool underneath covered the body of the woolly mammoth. Most adult woolly

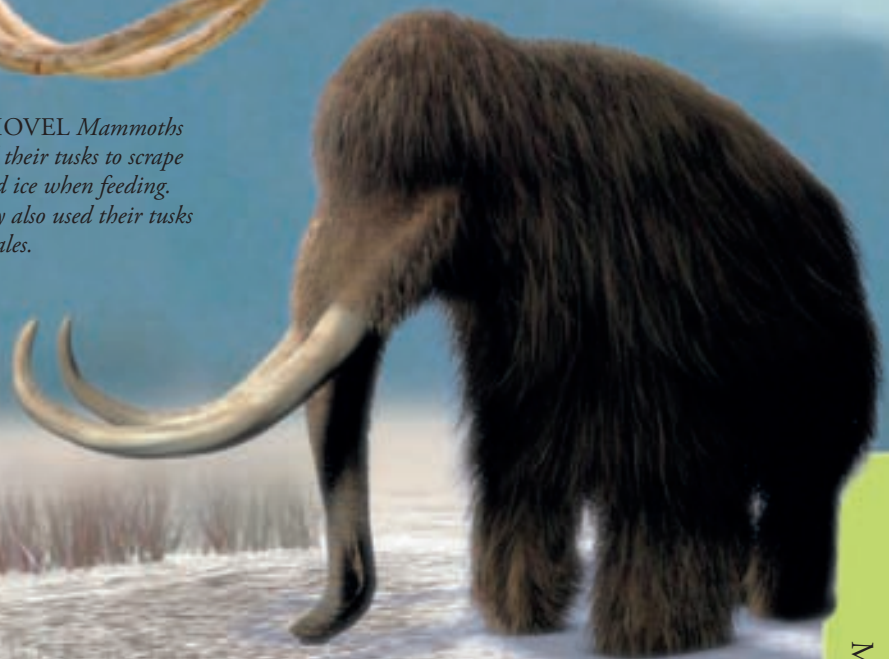
mammoths were slightly bigger than African elephants, but 6½ ft (2 m) tall “dwarf woolly mammoths” have also been found on an Arctic island. Adults had a distinct camel-like hump on the shoulders and enormous, curved tusks. Mammoths lived in Ice age grasslands and had ridged teeth for chewing tough grass and other small plants. Studies of woolly mammoth DNA reveal they were more closely related to the Asian elephant than the African species.



▲ **BONE HUTS** Prehistoric people built oval or rounded huts from mammoth bones and tusks. About 30 clusters of these huts have been found in eastern Europe.



▲ **SNOW SHOVEL** Mammoths may have used their tusks to scrape away snow and ice when feeding. Males probably also used their tusks to impress females.



LIVING RELATIVE

When an Asian elephant is born, its body is covered with thick, brownish-red hair, similar to the shaggy coat of its relative the woolly mammoth. However, since the Asian elephant lives in a warm, tropical climate, it sheds its hair as it grows older. Most adults have only sparse hairy patches. African elephants have even less hair.



MAMMALS

